

A Self-Closing Gate Conundrum

#1 Victory Royale

Element J: Documentation of Evaluation

Student G's family needs a self-closing mechanism that closes their family's gate on its own because his family does not want unwanted animals and people to get inside their fence gate because it is a safety concern that could cause injury. This happens because student G's gate can not close on its own.

Mr. C is the land management teacher and has a gate at his farm and works on them a lot so he is very qualified for answering the questions. We asked Student G to ask him because Student G has a class with Mr. C everyday. Mr. F is the maintenance manager so he works on fences very often and knows about how to fix problems on them. We asked him to give us feedback about our prototype. Student G's mother is the owner of the gate and understands the problem we are trying to solve. She has given us feedback to try and we have found one that works.

Mr. C and Mr. F both said that we need to put a piece of material such as rubber, fabric, or foam in between or around the gate where we put the prototype so it does not scratch the paint. Student G's Mom said it cannot scratch the paint off the fence, the fence has to close. Pretty much all she said matches our criteria.

The feedback we had got from our stakeholders and experts was to just put something in between or around the gate where we will put the prototype so it does not scratch the paint off.